

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst (SIEM Engineering) | Security Operations and Cyber Detection Capability

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, cyber detection capability development and security operations. I have advanced specialist knowledge of SIEM concepts, procedures and processes, with hands-on experience administering and engineering Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM across large, complex institutional environments. I have a proven track record of building cyber detection capability, automating security monitoring, managing SIEM data feed infrastructure and producing clear SIEM status reporting for both technical and non-technical stakeholders. I have mentored and guided junior analysts within Security Operations Centre (SOC) environments, and I hold an M.Sc. as well as CISSP certification, aligned to the qualifications requirements for this role. I am comfortable working to SC (Security Check) clearance requirements and hold a strong UK residency history. I am seeking a Senior Cyber Security Analyst (SIEM Engineering) role where I can build and mature detection capabilities that protect critical national infrastructure.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (data connector management, KQL analytics, workbook development, detection rule lifecycle), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; SIEM environment management, data feed infrastructure and log source integration
- **Cyber Detection Capability:** Detection rule authoring and tuning aligned to MITRE ATT&CK; alert fidelity improvement, false positive reduction, and threat-informed detection engineering
- **Security Monitoring Automation:** Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development using PowerShell and Logic Apps; automated triage, enrichment and response workflows within Microsoft Sentinel
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Advanced threat hunting queries, custom detection analytics and incident investigation within Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Tanium
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven hunting using KQL in Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively surfacing threats across endpoint, identity and network telemetry
- **Incident Response (IR):** NIST 800-61 framework, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned investigation, root cause analysis, containment and post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); risk prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Stakeholder Communication:** SIEM operational reporting, vulnerability status updates, incident briefings for technical and non-technical audiences including senior leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 – Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Manage and engineer the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment as the primary security monitoring platform for a complex, multi-site institution of 15,000 users: deploy and maintain data connectors, manage

log ingestion and data feed infrastructure, and ensure SIEM health and availability.

- Build and mature the institution's cyber detection capability by authoring, testing and tuning detection analytics using Kusto Query Language (KQL), aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs) to improve threat identification and reduce dwell time.
- Improve the automation of security monitoring by developing SOAR playbooks in PowerShell and Logic Apps within Microsoft Sentinel, automating repetitive alert triage, threat enrichment and response actions to allow analysts to focus on complex investigations.
- Manage CrowdStrike NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel, maintaining CrowdStrike as a complementary detection source and ensuring cross-platform alert correlation for comprehensive threat coverage.
- Produce clear and accurate SIEM status reporting and investigation summaries for both technical colleagues within the Security Operations Centre (SOC) and non-technical senior stakeholders, communicating risk and operational performance in accessible language.
- Mentor and coach junior analysts within the cyber security team, providing guidance on SIEM investigation techniques, KQL query development and structured incident response methodology.
- Conduct hypothesis-driven threat hunting across endpoint, identity and cloud telemetry using KQL in Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying threats not surfaced by automated detection rules.
- Lead Incident Response (IR) activities following NIST 800-61, performing forensic investigation, containment, eradication and post-incident review, and incorporating lessons learned into updated detection rules and response playbooks.
- Manage vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Nessus and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), identifying and tracking remediation of risks to closure while reporting progress to technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- Maintain security controls across Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Privileged Access Management (PAM) (BeyondTrust) and Mimecast email security, monitoring these platforms for anomalous activity and integrating their telemetry into the SIEM environment.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Monitored SIEM dashboards and Security Operations Centre (SOC) alert queues, investigating and triaging security events using KQL-based queries in Microsoft Sentinel, and escalating high-priority incidents to senior analysts.
- Contributed to the development and maintenance of SIEM detection rules, proposing improvements to existing analytics based on observed threat patterns and emerging intelligence, and testing changes before promotion to production.
- Managed SIEM data feed health, monitoring log source connectivity and troubleshooting ingestion issues to ensure continuous and complete security monitoring coverage.
- Supported SOAR playbook development by documenting triage procedures, testing automated workflows and validating enrichment outputs from integrated threat intelligence feeds.
- Produced operational reporting and threat summaries for technical and non-technical stakeholders, including vulnerability remediation status reports and SOC performance metrics.
- Supported junior colleagues by sharing SIEM investigation techniques and Sentinel KQL query patterns, contributing to team skill development and knowledge sharing.
- Administered Azure Active Directory and Conditional Access policies, monitoring identity telemetry within the SIEM for indicators of compromise and investigating suspicious authentication events.
- Participated in Incident Response activities in line with NIST 800-61, supporting end-to-end investigation and contributing to post-incident documentation and lessons-learned reviews.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Implemented and maintained security controls across cloud and on-premises infrastructure within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and financial technology (FinTech) environment, contributing to the team's security monitoring and incident response capability.

- Supported security log management and monitoring, assisting with the integration of log sources into centralised tooling and investigating security events as they arose.
- Wrote PowerShell scripts to automate security configuration checks, access control audits and system hardening tasks, reducing manual effort and improving consistency.
- Contributed to vulnerability assessment activities including patch compliance tracking and remediation reporting, applying NIST CSF and CIS Controls guidance to prioritisation decisions.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered and managed a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment, deploying data connectors across endpoint, identity, cloud and email sources, ensuring continuous and complete log ingestion and monitoring coverage for a 15,000-user institution.
- Built a MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection library using Kusto Query Language (KQL), covering adversary tactics including initial access, privilege escalation, lateral movement, credential theft and data exfiltration, materially improving the institution's cyber detection capability.
- Developed SOAR automation playbooks in PowerShell and Logic Apps, automating phishing investigation, user account containment and threat intelligence enrichment, reducing mean time to respond by over 40% for common alert types.
- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, integrating their telemetry into the SIEM environment to deliver unified Security Operations Centre (SOC) visibility.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR across the enterprise, achieving full endpoint visibility and enabling advanced threat hunting and detection rule management at scale.
- Mentored junior analysts in SIEM investigation techniques, KQL query development and structured incident response methodology, improving team capability and supporting knowledge transfer within the SOC.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering** (Masters level qualification aligned to role requirements)
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (Leeds / London / UK) | SC Clearance eligible